

Eduloan

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Project Overview

The Product

This Student Loan App is a digital platform that connects students who need educational loans with investors willing to fund them. The app simplifies the loan process, reduces paperwork, and ensures transparency for both users. It focuses on providing quick, secure, and user-friendly loan access.

Project Duration

The project was completed over a period of 8–12 weeks, covering research, design, and planning stages. Each phase was structured to ensure smooth progress. The timeline allowed sufficient iteration for improving the overall user experience.

Project Overview



Problem Statement

Students struggle to find reliable loan providers and face long, confusing processes. Investors also lack a secure system to lend money and track repayments. A unified digital solution is needed to connect both parties safely and efficiently.



The Goal

- Provide students an easy and quick loan process.
- Give investors a secure and transparent lending system.
- Reduce paperwork through a fully digital platform.
- Ensure smooth and user-friendly experience for both users.

Project Overview

My Role

As a UI/UX Designer, I handled the research, wireframes, and final interface design. I worked on creating intuitive user flows and ensuring the app is easy to navigate. My role also included presenting and refining the design based on feedback.

Responsibilities

I conducted user research, created personas, and designed wireframes for both user roles. I developed clean UI screens ensuring clarity and usability. I also prepared prototypes, tested interactions, and delivered the final design documentation.

Understanding the user

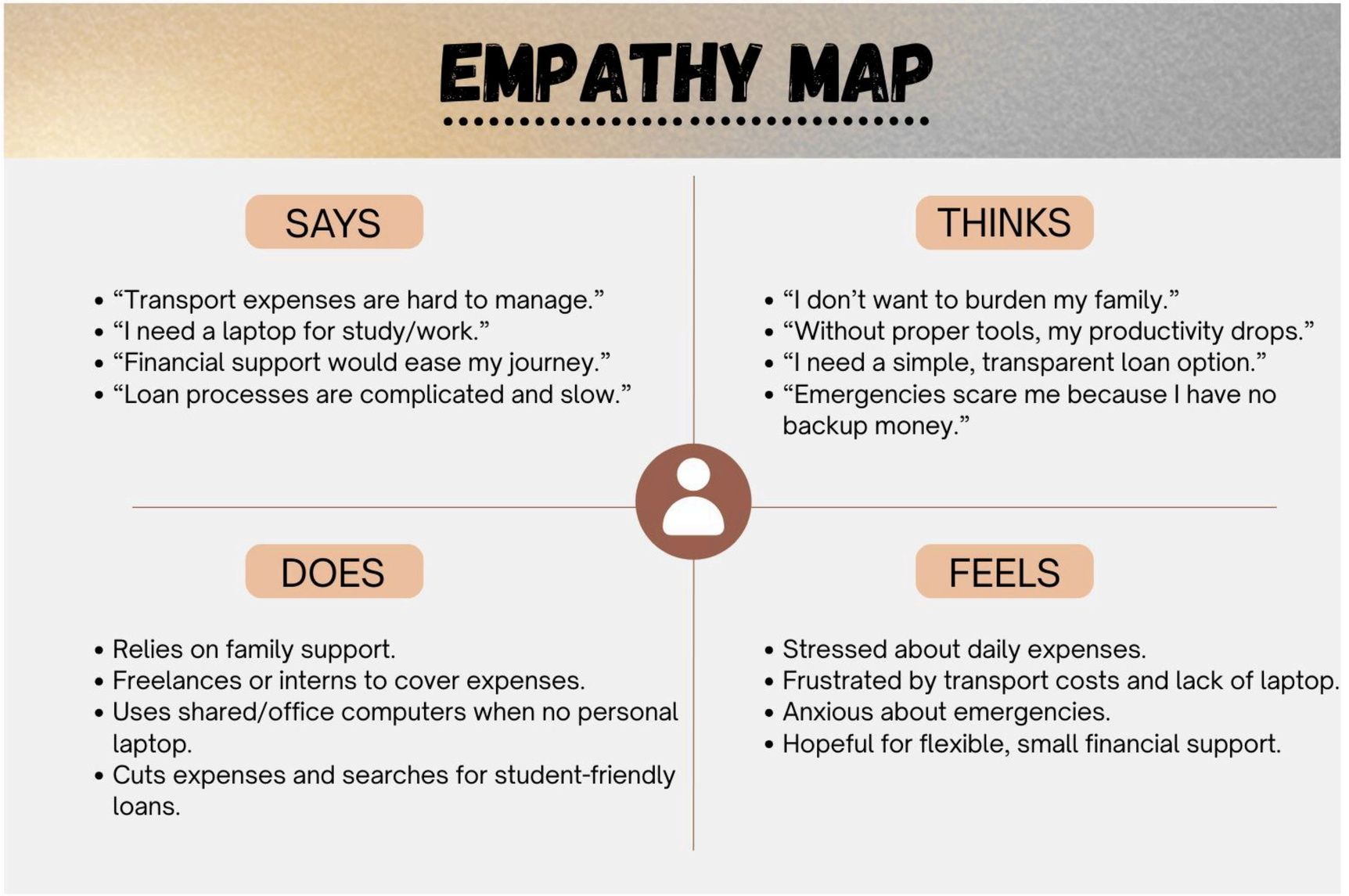
- User research
- Research Summary
- Empathy maps
- Personas
- Accessibility Considerations
- User journey maps
- Competitive analysis
- Usability findings
- Pain points



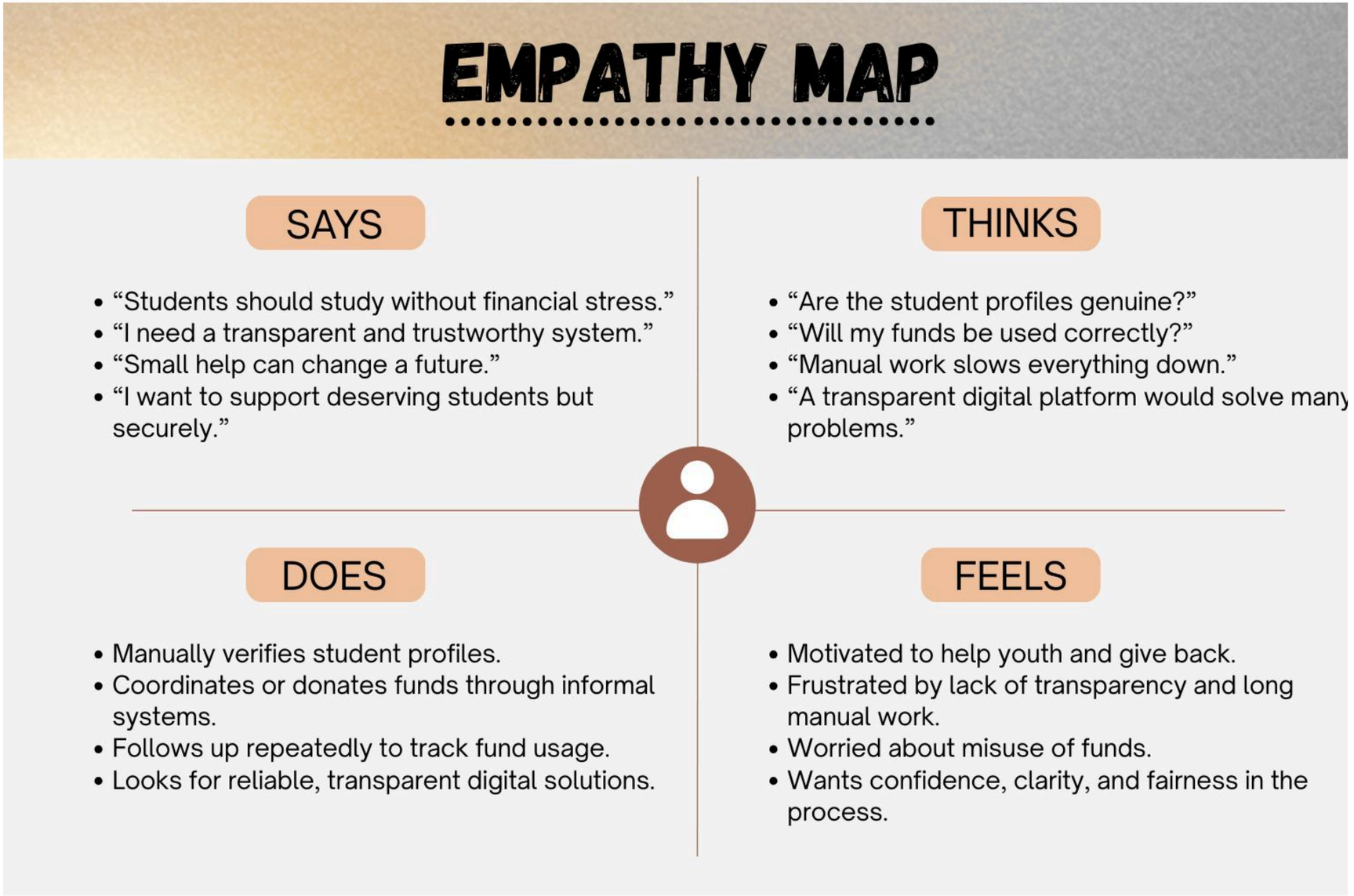
User Research

For this project, I conducted basic user interviews and online surveys with both students and potential investors to understand their loan-related challenges. Initially, I assumed that students mainly struggled with documentation, but the research revealed that trust, transparency, and response time were bigger concerns. I also assumed investors only cared about profit, but findings showed they also wanted a secure platform and clear repayment tracking. These insights helped refine the app features to focus more on trust, security, and a simplified loan process.

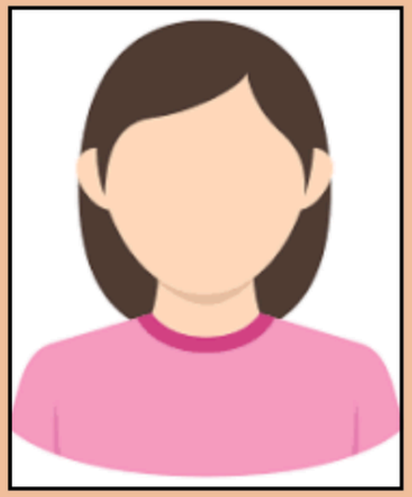
Empathy Map (Student)



Empathy Map (Contributor)



Personas (Student)



Yusra is a 20-year-old hostelite student pursuing Product and Industrial Design. Being away from home, she manages her own expenses including hostel rent, transportation, and study essentials. While her family supports her, extra costs like gadgets, medical expenses, or emergencies are challenging to manage. Yusra wishes for a reliable student loan application that provides small, flexible loans for education-related needs, helping her stay focused on her studies.

YUSRA TARIQ

"I want to focus on my studies without worrying too much about daily expenses and hostel dues. A little financial support would make my student life much easier!"

Age: 20
Education: Undergraduate student (Product & Industrial Design)
Hometown: Sahiwal, Pakistan
Family: Single Lives in hostel, family resides in hometown
Occupation: Full-time student

Goals

- To manage hostel expenses without burdening family.
- To buy necessary items like laptop/phone for study purposes.
- To have access to emergency funds for medical needs.
- To focus on academics without financial stress.

Frustrations

- Hostel dues and daily expenses create financial pressure.
- Difficult to buy essential items like laptop or bike on her own.
- Medical emergencies are hard to cover without extra funds.
- Lack of flexible student-friendly loan options.

Personas (Student)



Saad Nadeem is a 20-year-old BSCS undergraduate from Lahore. He aims to become a software engineer or start his own venture while building strong technical skills. Mostly relying on family support, he sometimes freelances to cover expenses but struggles with tuition fees, transport, and the need for a laptop. Ambitious and tech-savvy, he seeks a small, transparent student loan with flexible repayment to continue his studies smoothly.

Saad Nadeem

I want to complete my degree but daily transport expenses and the lack of a laptop make it difficult to manage. A little financial support would ease my journey.

Age: 20
Education: BSCS (Bachelor of Science in Computer Science)
Hometown:Lahore, Pakistan
Family: family resides in hometown
Occupation: Full time Student

Goals

- Get a small student loan for semester fees and a laptop.
- Prefer low, transparent costs with fixed monthly repayments.
- Start building credit history for future financial needs.
- Continue studies smoothly and focus on academic projects.

Frustrations

- Complicated forms and heavy paperwork.
- Slow approvals with unclear eligibility.
- High costs or hidden charges.
- Rigid repayment plans that don’t match income.

Personas (Student)



Tuba, a 21-year-old BBA student from Lahore, is currently doing an internship. While gaining valuable experience, high daily transport costs strain her finances. Without a personal laptop, she relies on office computers, limiting her productivity. Financial support through a student loan app could help her manage transport expenses and invest in a laptop to boost her academic and professional growth.

TUBA AHSAN

"I want to complete my degree and internship successfully, but daily transport expenses and not having a laptop make it hard to manage. A little financial support would ease my journey."

Age: 21 Year
Education: BBA Student
Hometown: Lahore, Pakistan
Family: Lives with family in Lahore
Occupation: Student + Intern

Goals

- To manage transportation costs for daily internship travel.
- To own a personal laptop for flexible work and study instead of relying only on office computers.
- To balance academics with internship responsibilities.

Frustrations

- High transport costs consume most of her stipend.
- No personal laptop limits work after office hours.
- Finds it hard to save for essential study tools

Personas (Contributor)



Mr. Imran Malik

"Someone once helped me when I needed it most now I want to help students do the same."

Age: 30 Year
Education: MBA – Finance
Hometown: Karachi, Pakistan
Family: Married, 1 child
Occupation: Financial Analyst / Social Investor

Imran Malik is a 30-year-old financial analyst from Karachi. During his student life, he once received financial help that changed his future. Now, he wants to extend the same support to others. However, he struggles to find a transparent and trustworthy way to assist deserving students. A student loan app offering verified profiles and clear impact tracking gives him the confidence to invest in students' growth while fulfilling his desire to give back.

Goals

- To support deserving students through small, impactful loans.
- To give back to society by helping youth complete their education.
- To use a transparent digital platform for student funding.

Frustrations

- Unsure where donations or funds are actually used.
- No reliable system to connect with genuine students.
- Wants secure and trackable ways to offer help.

Personas (Contributor)



Ahmed Khan is a 42-year-old venture capitalist from Karachi with 15+ years of experience in finance and investments. Holding an MBA in Finance and CFA certification, he specializes in early-stage startups in fintech, edtech, and healthtech. He values transparent financial planning, scalable business models, and impactful innovation. In his free time, he follows global financial trends and mentors young entrepreneurs.

Ahmed Khan

"A seasoned venture capitalist with 15+ years of experience in funding and mentoring innovative startups."

Age: 42
Education: MBA in Finance (LUMS), CFA certified
Hometown: Karachi, Pakistan
Family: family resides in hometown
Occupation: senior Partner at a Venture Capital Firm

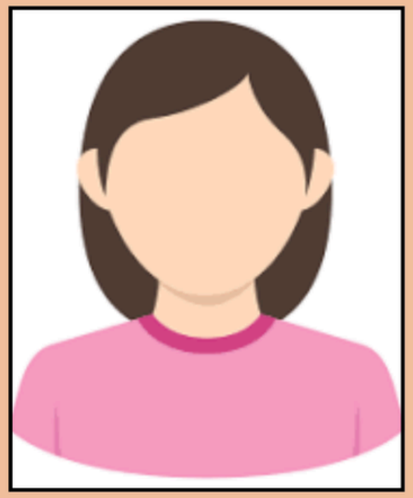
Goals

- Invest in startups with sustainable and scalable models.
- Achieve high ROI with balanced risk.
- Support businesses that create social and economic impact.
- Build long-term partnerships with promising founders.

Frustrations

- Lack of transparency in financial reporting.
- Weak business models without growth strategy.
- Overvaluation of startups with little traction.
- Poor communication or unprepared founders.

Personas (Contributor)



Sana Ahmed, a 33-year-old lecturer from Islamabad, helps underprivileged students manage scholarships. When institutions cover 50% of fees, she arranges the rest through local donors. Passionate about education, she bridges the gap between students and financial support — but manual management is tough. A student loan or funding app could simplify her work by linking verified students with trusted sponsors transparently.

Ms. Sana Ahmed

"I just want every capable student to study without worrying about money even small help can change a future."

Age: 33 Year
Education: MPhil – Education Management
Hometown: Islamabad, Pakistan
Family: Lives with parents, single
Occupation: College Lecturer / Scholarship Coordinator

Goals

- To help bright students continue their studies without financial stress.
- To connect students with reliable sponsors or donors.
- To promote fairness and transparency in scholarship distribution.

Frustrations

- Limited resources to support all deserving students.
- Manual, time-consuming process of managing student aid.
- Difficulty tracking how funds are used after distribution.

User Journey Map (Student)

User Journey Map

ACTIONS	ACTION 1	ACTION 2	ACTION 3	ACTION 4	ACTION 5	ACTION 6
TASK	Struggles with transport and fees	Borrows money from friends or family	Searches for part-time freelance work	Delays in paying semester fee	Academic stress increases	Tries to arrange emergency financial help
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Stressed	Embarrassed	Exhausted	Worried	Anxious	Helpless
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Loan category for transport and daily expenses	Quick access to small instant loans	Option for micro-loans linked to skills or freelancing income	Flexible installment plans for semester fees	In-app financial guidance and reminders	Emergency loan option with fast approval

User Journey Map (Contributor)

User Journey Map

ACTIONS	ACTION 1	ACTION 2	ACTION 3	ACTION 4	ACTION 5	ACTION 6
TASK	Looks for new investment opportunities	Reviews business proposals from startups	Evaluates app idea and financial model	Meets founders to discuss growth potential	Considers risks and return on investment	Decides to invest and track app performance
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Curious	Interested	Analytical	Confident	Cautious	Satisfied
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Provide clear investor dashboard with insights	Share transparent business and user growth data	Show realistic profit projections and impact metrics	Highlight scalability and student market demand	Build investor trust through secure transactions	Offer regular progress reports and ROI tracking tools

Competitive Analysis

Competitive audit	Competitive audit goal				
				General information	
	Competitor type (direct or indirect)	Location(s)	Product offering	Price ($ - $$$$)	Website (URL)
EduFi	Direct	Pakistan (Karachi, Lahore,nationwide digital)	Digital student financing (Study-Now-Pay-Later)	$ (low / micro installment based)	https://edufi.pk
Abhi (Salary Finance model used by students)	Direct	Pakistan (major urban centers)	Instant micro -finance / salary advance loan	$$ (service/processing fee)	https://abhi.ae/pk
Ehsaas Undergraduate Scholarship	Indirect	Pakistan (public universities nationwide)	Government-funded scholarships(need-based financial support)	Free	https://www.hec.gov.pk
Akhuwat Education Loan	Indirect	Pakistan (branch network nationwide)	Interest-free education loan (Qarz-e-Hasana model)	Free / donation-backed	https://akhuwat.org.pk

Competitive Analysis

Competitive audit	Business size (small, medium, large)	Target audience	Unique value proposition
EduFi	Small–Medium fintech startup	University and college students who cannot afford full tuition upfront	Quick education loan approval with digital KYC and flexible repayment options
Abhi (Salary Finance model used by students)	Medium–Large fintech	Young working students / students with guarantor / emerging youth borrowers	Instant loan disbursement within minutes through a verified digital process
Ehsaas Undergraduate Scholarship	Large (government-funded national scheme)	Low-income undergraduate students enrolled in recognized universities	Full or partial fee relief + stipend for eligible students with financial need
Akhuwat Education Loan	Large non-profit organization	Students from financially struggling families who need education financing	Shariah-compliant , zero-interest education loan

Competitive Analysis

Competitive audit	First impressions	
	Desktop website experience	App or mobile website experience
EduFi	**Rating: NEUTRAL** + Clean and minimal layout - Not enough details before signup	**Rating: GOOD** + Mobile-first & easy onboarding - Guidance/tutorials missing
Abhi (Salary Finance model used by students)	**Rating: GOOD** + Credible + trust focused - Not student-centric	**Rating: NEUTRAL** + Fast loan process - Built mainly for salaried users
Ehsaas Undergraduate Scholarship	**Rating: BAD** + Detailed scholarship info - Complex, outdated, heavy navigation	**Rating: BAD** + Accessible on phone (basic) - Not responsive / hard to apply
Akhuwat Education Loan	**Rating: NEUTRAL** + Trust building & storytelling - Informational only (no digital flow)	**Rating: BAD** + Opens easily on mobile - No app / offline-based journey

Competitive Analysis

Competitive audit	UX (rated: needs work, okay, good, or outstanding)			
	Interaction			
	Features	Accessibility	User flow	Navigation
EduFi	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Easy digital tuition financing system. Drawback: Limited repayment customization.	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Simple, mobile-first interface. Drawback: No screen-reader or disability support.	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Fast and simple onboarding. Drawback: No real-time tracking of application.	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Clean, student-friendly layout. Drawback: Limited help pages / fewer deep links.
Abhi (Salary Finance model used by students)	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Instant loan approval & disbursement. Drawback: Not tailored for students.	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: High-contrast UI, bold readability. Drawback: English-dominant → not accessible for rural users.	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Very fast verification process. Drawback: Requires salary slip/guarantor → barrier for students.	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Quick shortcuts and tab layout. Drawback: Finance-centric navigation (not academic).
Ehsaas Undergraduate Scholarship	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Full support (fee + stipend). Drawback: Very long approval timeline.	**Rating: BAD** Success: Open to all low-income applicants. Drawback: Not mobile-friendly or optimized for disability tools.	**Rating: BAD** Success: Structured government pipeline. Drawback: Confusing and multi-step for first-time users.	**Rating: BAD** Success: Large information repository. Drawback: Scattered links, outdated layout.
Akhuwat Education Loan	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Completely interest-free education loan. Drawback: Offline/manual application system.	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Urdu-friendly and easy language. Drawback: No digital accessibility or online tracking.	**Rating: BAD** Success: Counseling support for students. Drawback: Approval depends on local branch capacity.	**Rating: NEUTRAL** Success: Simple informational pages. Drawback: No digital application journey.

Competitive Analysis

Competitive audit	Visual design	Content	
	Brand identity	**Tone**	**Descriptiveness**
EduFi	**Rating: GOOD** + Youth-friendly colors and soft gradients - Brand feels early-stage / startup level	Modern, student-centric, clean and trust-building tone in visuals.	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Clear academic UI with smooth icons and hierarchy. Drawback: Interface feels slightly generic and lacks unique student personality.
Abhi (Salary Finance model used by students)	**Rating: GOOD** + Professional + high trust look - Corporate feel (not student-emotional design) - Design tone is more HR/B2B focused	Sleek, fintech-professional tone with modern UI language.	**Rating: GOOD** Success: Clean, premium-looking layout with strong readability and bold CTAs. Drawback: Feels too corporate; not very friendly for younger or student users.
Ehsaas Undergraduate Scholarship	**Rating: BAD** + Government identity recognizable - Patchy layout, outdated interface - Heavy text blocks, low visual clarity	Rigid, bureaucratic and informational tone — not visual-first.	**Rating: BAD** Success: Basic information is available in a straightforward manner. Drawback: Outdated design, cluttered layout, and no modern visual hierarchy.
Akhuwat Education Loan	**Rating: NEUTRAL** + Culturally rooted and trust-heavy imagery + Human/empathy-based visuals - Feels non-digital / NGO style, not app-ready	Conservative, socially-oriented tone, minimal emphasis on design.	**Rating: NEUTRAL (leaning BAD)** Success: Trust-building, culturally familiar visuals that match its social mission. Drawback: Very basic, text-heavy design with no proper UI or modern visual appeal.

Usabaility Findings

- Some users felt confused between “Apply Loan” and “Check Status,” so icons and clearer wording were added.
- Both user groups requested faster navigation, leading to improved button placement and shorter flows.
- Testers appreciated the clean layout but suggested adding progress indicators to reduce uncertainty during form filling.
- Users found the loan application steps simple, but wanted fewer input fields to save time.
- Students struggled to understand loan terms, so clearer labels and tooltips were needed.
- Investors wanted a more visible dashboard to track repayments quickly.

Acessibility Considerations

Clear text labels and high-contrast elements were used to help users with low vision easily read and navigate the app.

Simple icons and consistent layouts were added to support users with cognitive or learning difficulties.

Larger tap targets and readable font sizes were ensured so users with motor limitations can interact without difficulty.

Pain Points

- Daily academic and living expenses (transport, laptop, fees) are difficult to manage with limited family support.
- Loan processes are complicated, full of paperwork, and take too long for approval.
- Lack of transparency in costs, hidden charges, and unclear eligibility create trust issues.
- Repayment plans are often rigid and don’t match students’ monthly income or financial situation.

- Manual student aid management is time-consuming and requires handling multiple documents.
- Limited resources make it hard to support every deserving student fairly.
- No reliable system to connect verified students with trusted sponsors or donors.
- Difficulty tracking how funds are used or ensuring transparency after distribution.

Starting the Design

Story Boards

Flow Chart

User Flow

Paper wireframes

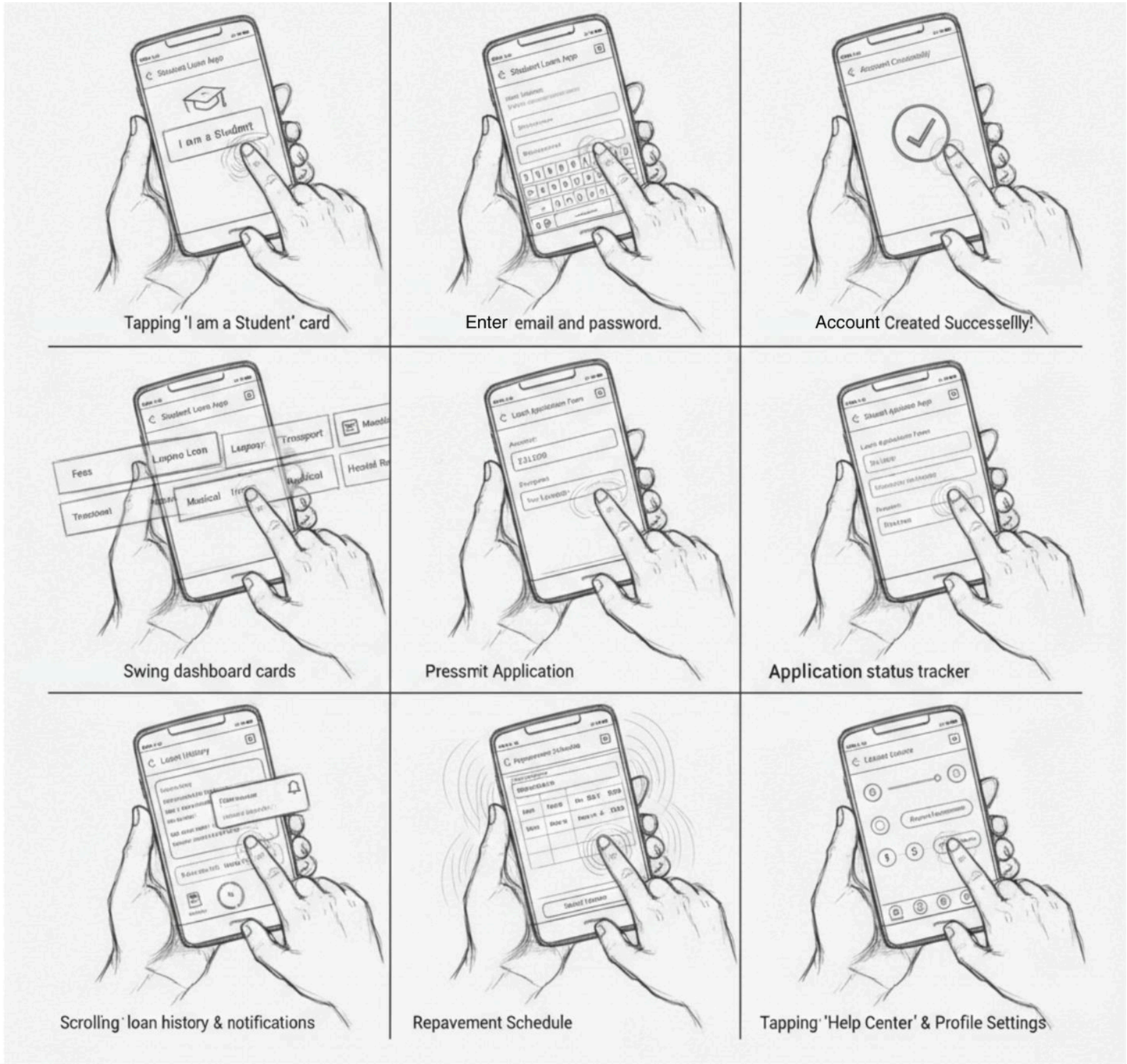
Action Explanation

Low-fidelity prototype

Sticker Sheet / Design System

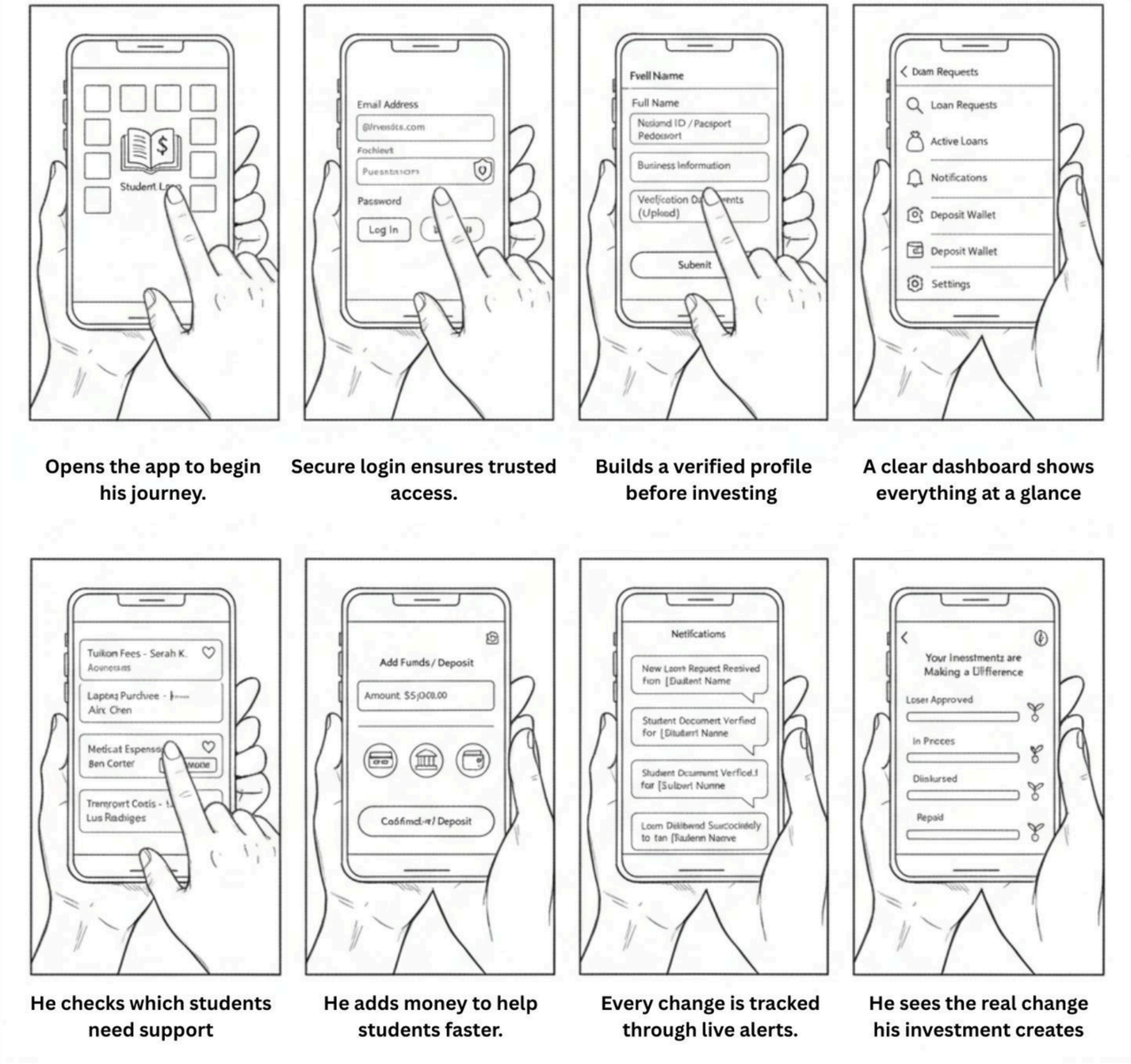
Story Boards

(Student close up)



Story Boards

(Contributor close up)



Story Boards

(Student Big Picture)



Feeling overwhelmed by rising tuition fees

Unable to afford essential study equipment

Daily commute becomes a constant challenge

Unexpected health costs strain the budget even more

Mental Stress from bills

Asking for any help??

Multiple financial issues lead to emotional exhaustion

Additional repair expenses increase financial pressure

A new possibility appears while browsing

The app provides clear loan options for student needs

Quick result brings relief and optimism

Student Solves major problems

Approved loan helps the student move forward

Hope Begins

A turnig point

A better Journey begins

Story Boards

(Contributor Big Picture)



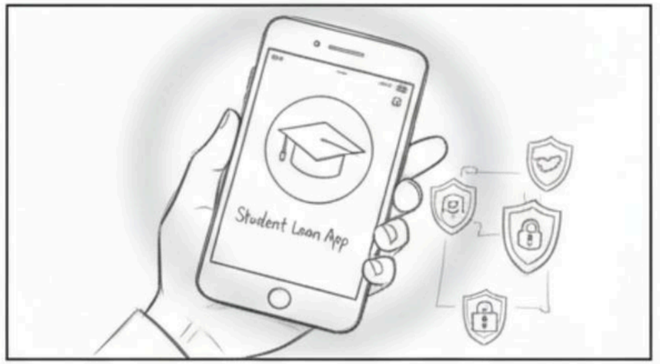
He remembers a time when he too needed help.



Now he wants for support students facing what what he once faced.



He searches for founders, but no trustworthy model appears.



Then he comes across the Student Loan App with clear features. secure process. real student support

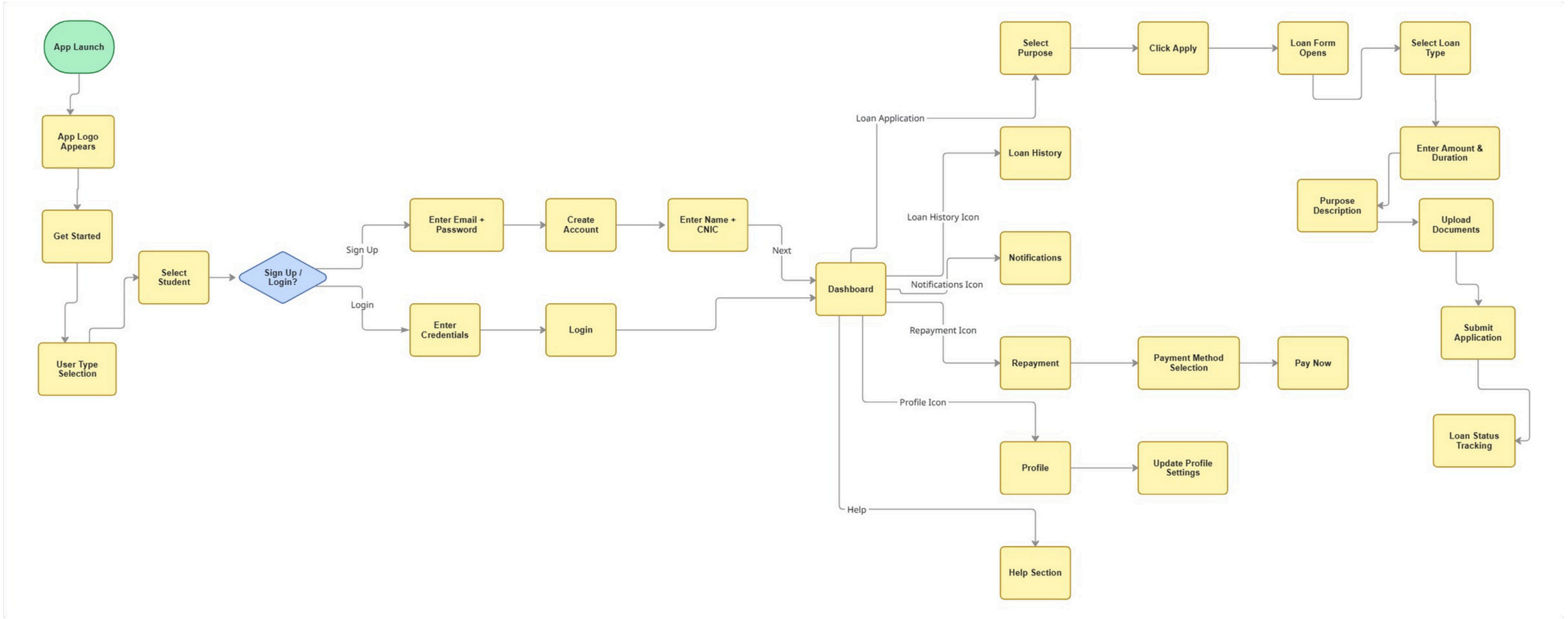


Students finally receiving the help they deserve.

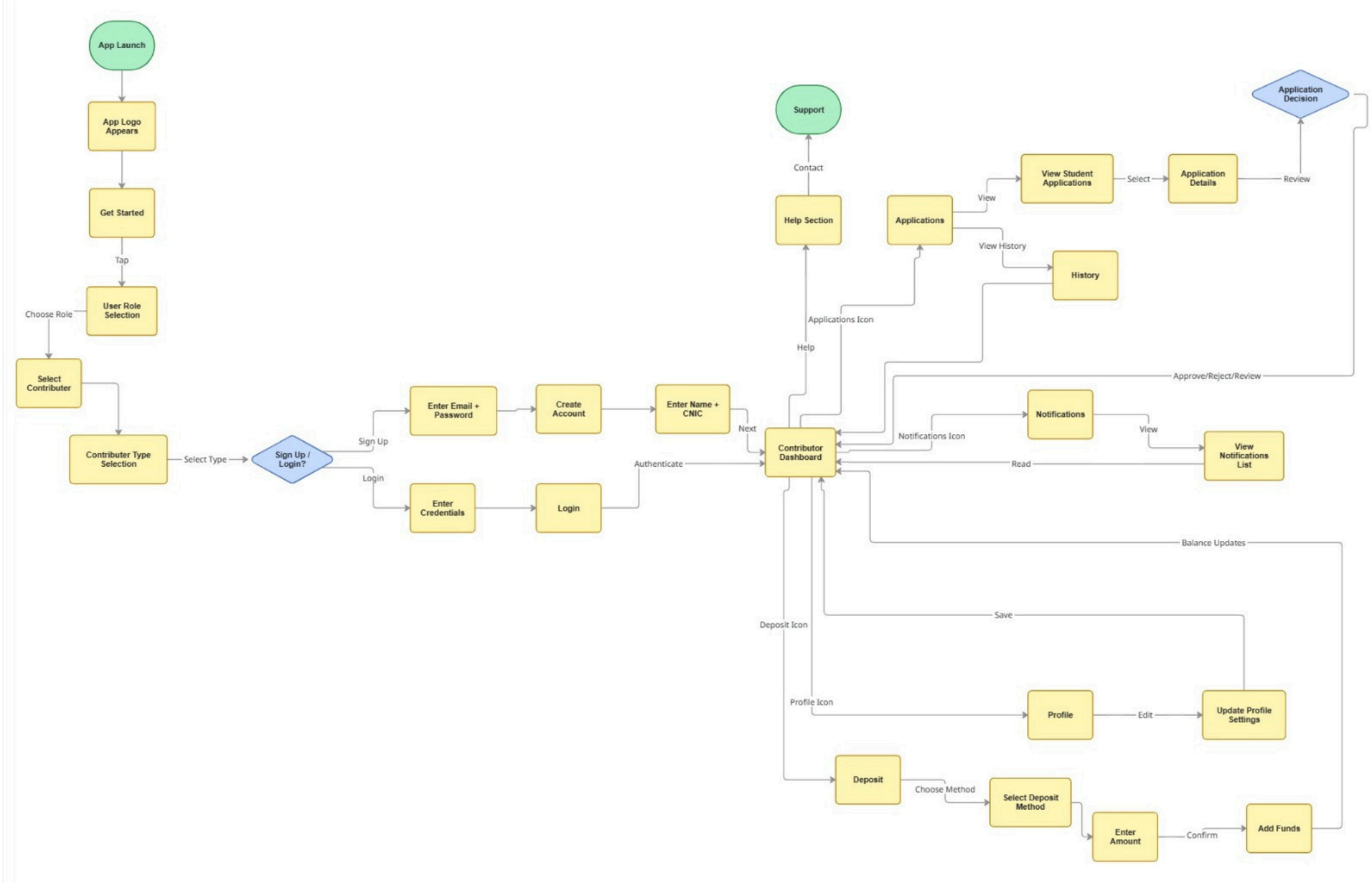


He invests–unlocking opportunities for thousands.

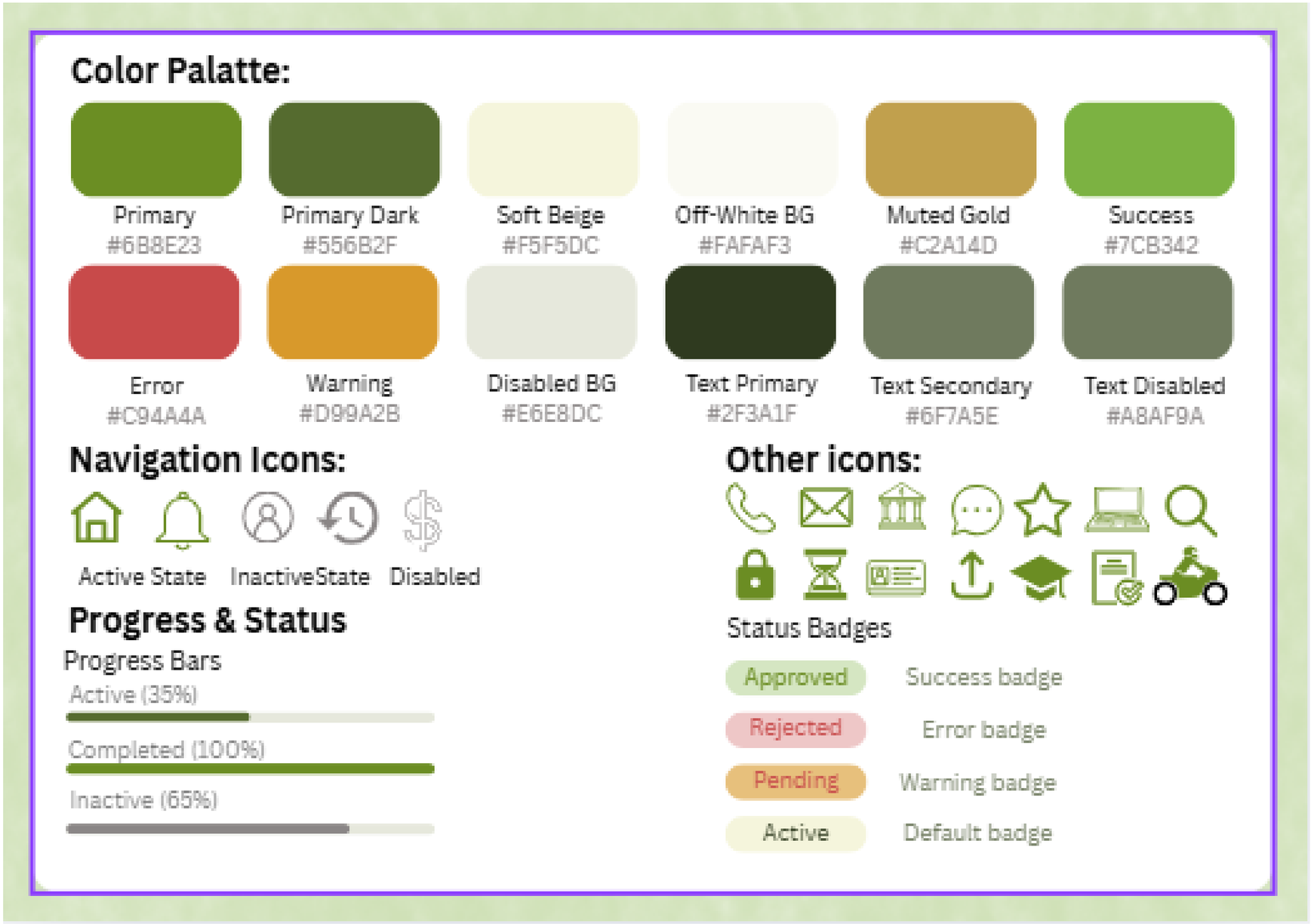
User Flow Chart (Student)



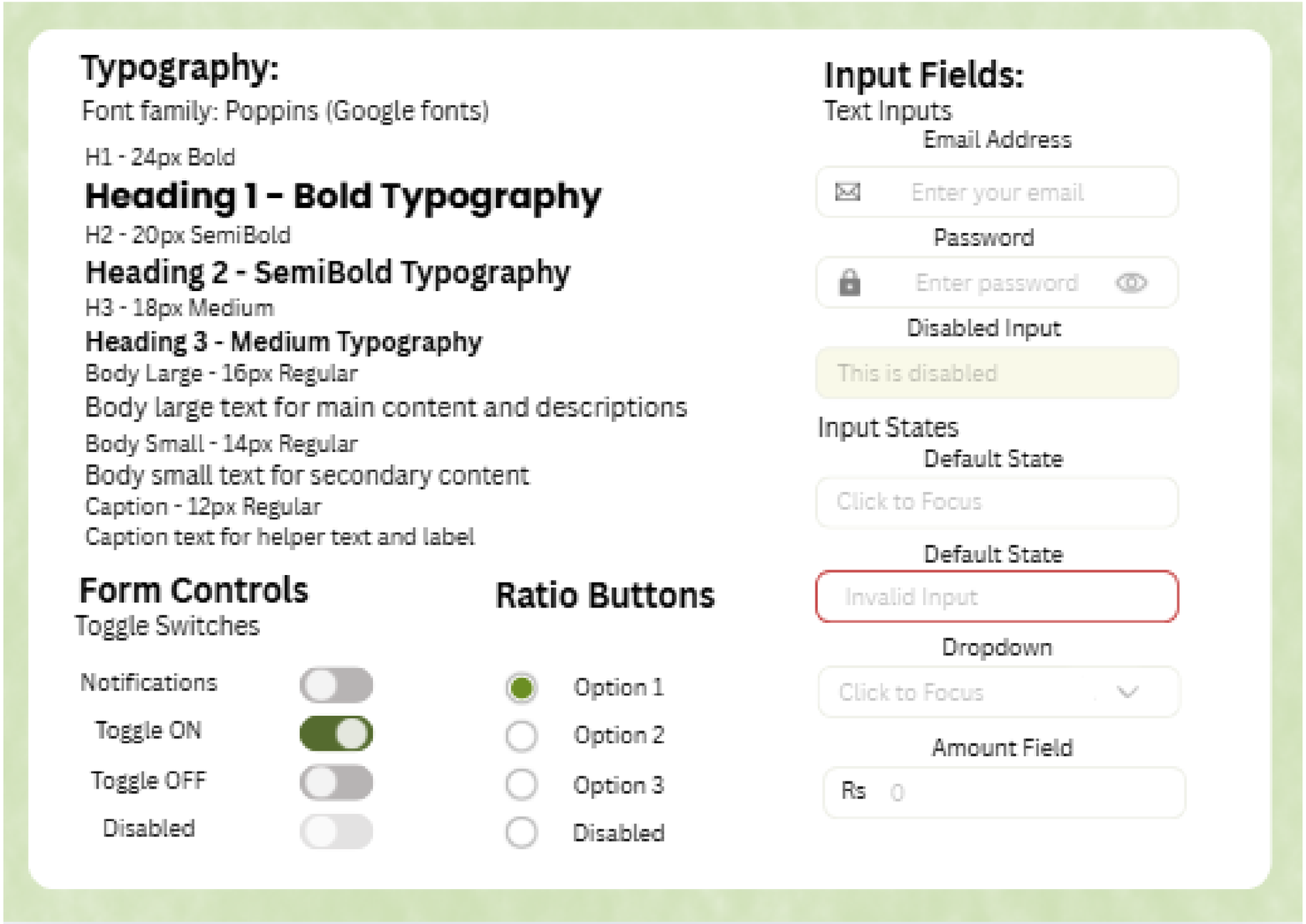
User Flow Chart (Investor)



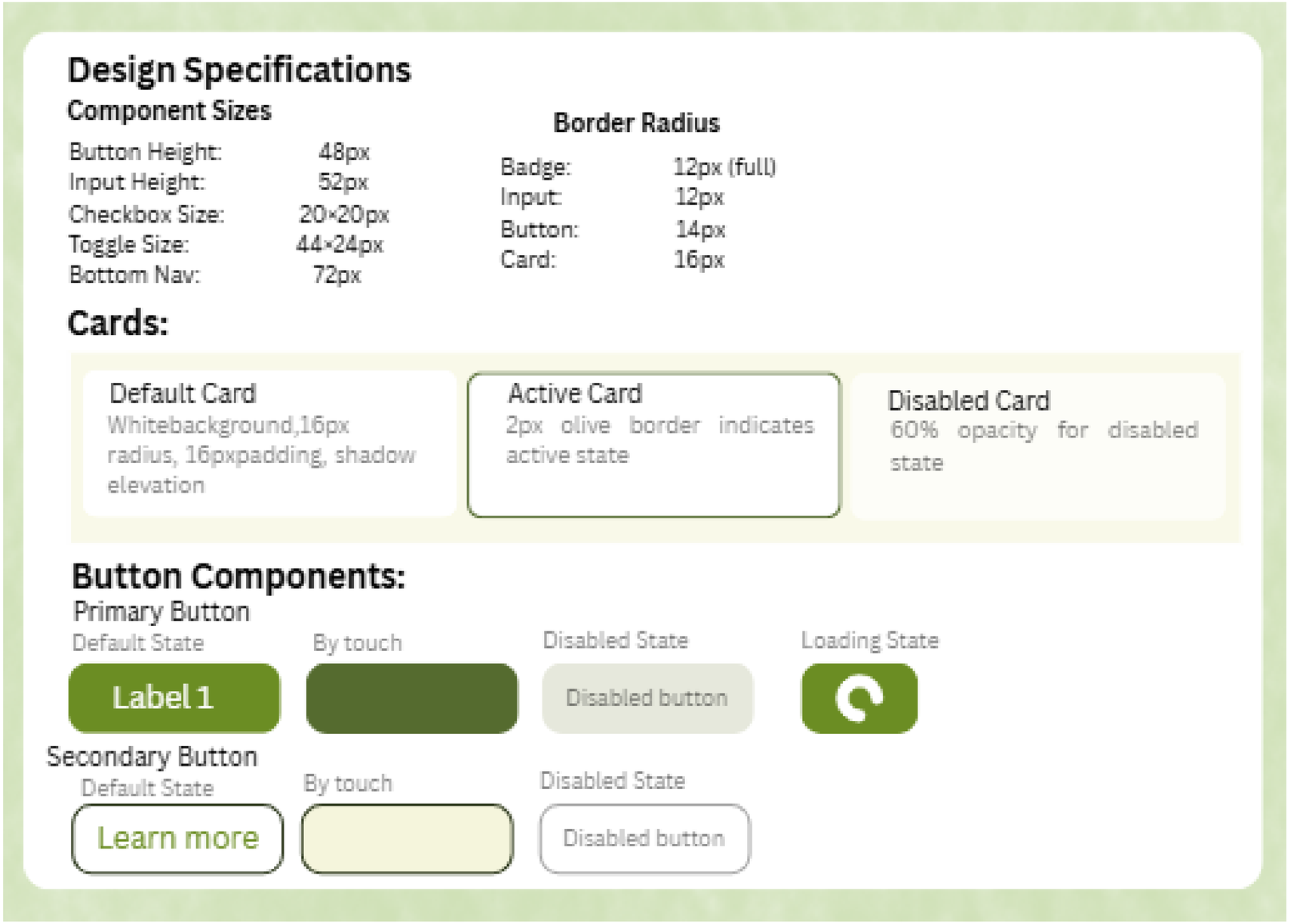
Sticker Sheet (Design system)



Sticker Sheet (Design system)



Sticker Sheet (Design system)



Usability Testing

Testing Methods

- Used moderated testing through jury reviews where users walked through the app and shared real-time feedback.
- Conducted peer walkthrough sessions to observe how easily users could complete tasks like applying for a loan or checking repayment status.
- Ran unmoderated testing by sharing the prototype link with peers to explore independently and submit written feedback.
- Tested key user flows such as sign-up, loan application, approval tracking, and repayment overview.
- Collected both qualitative feedback (comments, confusion points) and usability issues (navigation errors, time to complete tasks).

Feedback Summary

- Users liked the simple and clean interface but felt some forms were too long.
- Students were confused about loan terms, interest details, and eligibility criteria.
- Investors wanted a clearer and more visible repayment tracking dashboard.
- Some users mixed up similar buttons like “Apply Loan” and “Check Status.”
- Jury members suggested adding progress indicators and better visual hierarchy.

Usability Testing

Iterations & Improvements

- Reduced the number of form fields to make the loan application faster.
- Added clearer labels, tooltips, and explanations for loan terms and charges.
- Improved button text and icons to avoid confusion between actions.
- Added a progress bar to show form completion status.
- Redesigned the investor dashboard for better tracking and readability.

Design Rationale

Justification for UX/UI Decisions

- A simple and clean layout was chosen to reduce confusion during the loan application process.
- Step-by-step forms and progress indicators were added to guide users smoothly.
- Clear buttons, icons, and labels were used to avoid mistakes between similar actions.
- Dashboards were designed to give quick visibility of loan status and repayments.

Alignment with User Needs & Business Goals

- The design focuses on easy loan access for students and secure tracking for investors.
- Transparent information builds user trust and supports long-term platform growth.
- Faster workflows help increase user adoption and reduce drop-offs.
- A unified platform supports the business goal of connecting students and investors digitally.

Design Rationale

Challenges & Learnings

- Balancing detailed loan information with a simple UI was a major challenge.
- Designing for two user roles (student + investor) required clear navigation separation.
- User feedback showed the importance of trust, clarity, and transparency in finance apps.
- Learned that early usability testing saves time and improves final design quality.

Conclusion

Summary of Outcomes

- A user-friendly Student Loan App design was successfully created for both students and investors.
- The final design simplified the loan application and repayment tracking process.
- User research and testing helped improve clarity, trust, and overall usability.
- The app now offers a more transparent, secure, and efficient financial experience.

Future Recommendations

- Add AI-based eligibility checks for faster loan approvals.
- Integrate in-app chat support for real-time assistance.
- Include flexible repayment plan options for students.
- Add analytics for investors to track performance and impact.
- Conduct real-world user testing after development for further improvements.

References & Resources

Books, Articles, Websites, Tools Used

- Don’t Make Me Think by Steve Krug **(for usability principles)**
- The Design of Everyday Things by Don Norman **(for user-centered design)**
- Nielsen Norman Group articles **(for UX research and usability guidelines)**
- Material Design Guidelines **(for UI consistency and accessibility)**
- Figma **(for wireframing, UI design, and prototyping)**

Credits for Images, Icons, or Frameworks

- Icons from Material Icons / Font Awesome
- Illustrations from unDraw / Freepik
- UI framework inspired by Google Material Design
- Wireframing structure based on standard UX design patterns

THANKYOU